

Sahel Microfinance Bank Plc

Employee Handbook — 2023 Edition

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1. Introduction

Sahel Microfinance Bank Plc ("the Bank") operates twenty-two branches across Lagos, Ogun, Kaduna, Kano and the Federal Capital Territory. This handbook sets out the terms of employment, the conduct expected of staff, and the benefits available to confirmed employees. It supersedes all previous editions and all informal practices at branch level.

Where this handbook conflicts with an individual employment contract, the contract prevails. Where it conflicts with Nigerian labour law or a directive of the National Financial Services Commission, the law or directive prevails.

2. Employment categories

Staff are engaged in one of four categories. **Confirmed staff** have completed the probationary period and are entitled to the full range of benefits described in this handbook. **Probationary staff** serve six months from the date of resumption and accrue leave but may not draw against it. **Contract staff** are engaged for a fixed term and receive benefits only where the contract specifies them. **Corps members** on national service are supervised under a separate scheme administered by the Head of Human Capital.

3. Working hours and attendance

Standard hours are 08:00 to 17:00, Monday to Friday, with one hour for lunch. Branch staff in locations with Saturday banking operate a rota under which no member of staff works more than two Saturdays in any calendar month. Time off in lieu is granted at the branch manager's discretion and must be taken within the same quarter.

Persistent lateness, defined as arrival after 08:15 on more than four occasions in a calendar month, is treated as a conduct matter under section 8.

4. Annual leave

Confirmed staff are entitled to **21 working days** of paid annual leave each calendar year, exclusive of public holidays. Leave accrues monthly and may be taken from the seventh month of service. A maximum of 5 working days may be carried into the following year and must be exhausted by 31 March, after which the balance lapses without payment in lieu.

Leave applications require the approval of the line manager and, for absences exceeding ten consecutive working days, the approval of the divisional head. No more than two members of any branch team may be on leave simultaneously.

Staff at Assistant Manager grade and above are entitled to an additional three working days.

5. Other leave

Maternity leave of sixteen weeks is granted at full pay to female staff who have completed twelve months of continuous service. **Paternity leave** of five working days is granted within two months of the birth. **Compassionate leave** of up to five working days is granted on the death of a spouse, child, parent or sibling. **Study leave** may be granted for professional examinations relevant to the Bank's business, including the Chartered Institute of Bankers of Nigeria examinations, at the discretion of the Head of Human Capital.

Sick leave beyond two consecutive working days requires a medical certificate from a hospital on the Bank's approved provider list. Cumulative sick leave exceeding thirty working days in a rolling twelve-month period triggers a referral to the Bank's retained medical adviser.

6. Expenses and allowances

Staff travelling on Bank business outside their duty station are entitled to a per diem of **NGN 35,000 per night** for locations within Nigeria. The per diem covers meals and incidentals. Accommodation is booked centrally by the Administration unit and is not reimbursed if arranged privately without prior written approval.

Road travel between Lagos and Ibadan, Abuja and Kaduna, or any journey under three hours is undertaken by Bank vehicle or approved transport operator. Air travel requires the approval of the divisional head and is booked in economy class for all grades below General Manager.

Expense claims must be submitted within thirty days of the expenditure, supported by receipts. Claims submitted after this window are not payable. Fuel claims require the vehicle log to be attached.

7. Remote and hybrid work

Remote work is available to staff in Head Office functions on a maximum of one day per week, subject to written approval by the divisional head and renewed each quarter. Branch-facing roles, cash operations and internal control are excluded. Staff working remotely must be reachable on the Bank's telephone system during standard hours.

8. Conduct and discipline

The Bank operates a three-stage disciplinary process: verbal caution recorded on file, written warning, and final written warning. Gross misconduct — including fraud, unauthorised disclosure of customer information, falsification of records, and any act triggering a report under the Bank's anti-money-laundering obligations — bypasses the staged process and proceeds directly to a disciplinary panel.

Staff must declare any outside business interest in writing to the Head of Human Capital. Employment or directorship at another

financial institution is prohibited without written waiver.

9. Confidentiality and data protection

Customer information may not be removed from Bank premises, transmitted to personal email accounts, or stored on personal devices. The Bank processes personal data in accordance with the Nigeria Data Protection Act. Staff receiving a data subject access request must forward it to the Data Protection Officer within one working day and must not respond directly.

10. Exit

Confirmed staff give and receive one month's notice. Probationary staff give and receive two weeks. Exiting staff must complete clearance with Administration, Information Technology, Internal Control and Human Capital before the final salary is released. Accrued and untaken leave is paid in lieu on resignation but not on dismissal for gross misconduct.

11. Review

~~This handbook is reviewed every two years by the Head of Human Capital and approved by the Board Governance Committee. Interim amendments are circulated by internal memorandum and take effect from the date stated in the memorandum.~~

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